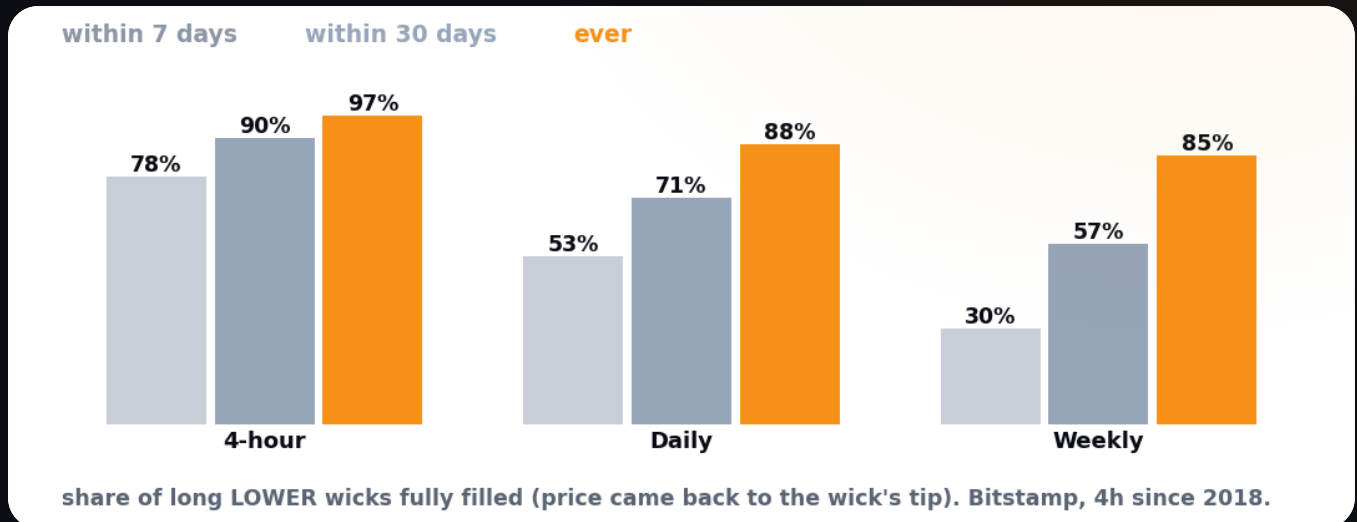


THE WICK FILL STUDY

Traders say every wick gets filled. I checked every long wick on Bitcoin's 4-hour, daily and weekly charts, 1,824 of them.

How often they fill, how fast, how much of the unfilled ones got filled, which never did, and how bull and bear years change the answer.



97%

of long 4-hour wicks down filled eventually

1 in 8

long daily wicks down never filled

100%

of long wicks up filled, on every chart

Educational, not financial advice. A long wick is a tail that makes up at least half the candle (and at least 1.5% of price on 4-hour, 3% on daily, 5% on weekly). A fill means price later trades back to the wick's tip.



Bitcoin Jae
@bitcoin.daily

THE ANSWER

HOW OFTEN WICKS FILL

WICKS	COUNT	WITHIN 24 HOURS	WITHIN 7 DAYS	WITHIN 30 DAYS	EVER	TYPICAL WAIT
4-hour, wicks down	687	51%	78%	90%	97%	1.0 days
4-hour, wicks up	430	49%	82%	91%	100%	1.2 days
Daily, wicks down	362	-	53%	71%	88%	5 days
Daily, wicks up	181	-	61%	78%	100%	5 days
Weekly, wicks down	86	-	30%	57%	85%	16 days
Weekly, wicks up	78	-	18%	62%	100%	22 days

Full fills only, price back to the wick's tip. Typical wait = median, among wicks that filled. 4-hour since 2018, daily and weekly since 2012, Bitstamp.

The smaller the candle, the more often and the faster its wick filled. On the 4-hour chart a wick down filled within a day about half the time and almost always eventually. On the daily chart about one long wick down in eight never filled. On the weekly, fewer than three in five filled within a month.

THE MARKET CHANGES IT

WICKS	COUNT	WITHIN 30 DAYS	EVER
Daily wicks down, bull years	266	68%	85%
Daily wicks down, bear years	96	81%	98%
Daily wicks up, bull years	114	82%	100%
Daily wicks up, bear years	67	70%	100%
Weekly wicks down, bull years	60	57%	80%
Weekly wicks down, bear years	26	58%	96%
Weekly wicks up, bull years	47	60%	100%
Weekly wicks up, bear years	31	65%	100%

Bear years = 2014, 2015, 2018, 2022, 2026 (the same list as every study on this page).

In bear years, wicks down got filled more often, because a falling market keeps revisiting lower prices. In bull years more of them were left behind. Wicks up filled 100% of the time eventually in both, because Bitcoin kept going on to new highs.

Bigger wicks fill less. The longest 20% of daily wicks down, 7.5% or more, filled within 30 days 59% of the time, against 71% for all of them, with a typical wait of 12 days.

WHEN THEY DO NOT FILL HOW MUCH DOES FILL

Of 362 long daily wicks down, 43 never fully filled. Price still came back a median 35% of the way into them, and only 6 were never touched at all. Most unfilled wicks get partly filled, then price leaves.

LONG DAILY WICK DOWN	WICK SIZE	TIP	HOW MUCH FILLED
31 Jan 2012	28.3%	\$3.80	77%
28 Jun 2012	7.7%	\$5.99	26%
02 Sep 2012	5.8%	\$9.49	98%
25 Jan 2013	6.0%	\$16.12	47%
14 Feb 2013	10.3%	\$22.42	0%
17 Feb 2013	6.4%	\$25.25	40%
23 Feb 2013	6.3%	\$27.67	25%
07 Mar 2013	20.8%	\$33.00	65%
12 Mar 2013	19.7%	\$36.00	7%
12 Apr 2013	44.5%	\$45.00	87%
16 Apr 2013	26.9%	\$49.80	44%
08 Jul 2013	5.2%	\$70.10	96%
09 Jul 2013	5.1%	\$70.25	0%
18 Jul 2013	9.7%	\$77.00	40%
02 Aug 2016	13.8%	\$465	25%
16 Mar 2020	11.9%	\$4,436	16%
18 Mar 2020	6.3%	\$5,007	22%
05 Aug 2024	8.2%	\$49,577	33%

Every daily wick down of 5% or more that price never came back to the tip of.

THE BOTTOMS

THE WICKS THAT NEVER FILLED



The biggest unfilled wicks were panic lows that started big rallies: August 2016 at \$465, March 2020 at \$4,436, March 2023 at \$19,569 and August 2024 at \$49,577. Price never went back. The wick that never fills is usually the bottom.

The limits. The 4-hour data starts in 2018. Wicks up filling every time reflects Bitcoin's long climb to new highs, not a law. Early years traded on a thin market with extreme wicks. None of this says whether a particular wick will fill, only how often similar ones did.

Data pinned 6 October 2026. Bitstamp BTC/USD 4-hour, daily and weekly bars. Scripts: WickFill/wf_study.py, WickFill/wf_4h.py, WickFill/wf_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

BITCOIN DAILY

COME FIND ME

This is the kind of breakdown I do every day. The hype brings the noise. I bring the data.



bitcoin-daily.com

Every free guide, the live cycle charts, and the daily blog, all in one place
bitcoin-daily.com/guides



Instagram

The live read every morning, daily charts, and the honest call on the market
[@bitcoin.daily](https://www.instagram.com/bitcoin.daily)



YouTube

Deep breakdowns like this one, every claim checked against the data
[bitcoindailytv](https://www.youtube.com/bitcoindailytv)



X / Twitter

More data threads like this one
[@BitcoinxDaily](https://twitter.com/BitcoinxDaily)



Bitcoin Jae

@bitcoin.daily · Educational, not financial advice

